JADE ZHAO

Bloomington, IN | jlzhao@iu.edu | linkedin.com/in/zhao-langxi | github.com/jadexzhao |
jadexzhao.github.io/jadexzhao/

Research Interests

Human-Centred AI | Digital Humans & Agentic Systems | Uncanny Valley | Anthropomorphism | Trust Calibration | Information Behaviour | Health Informatics | Responsible AI

Education

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN

Luddy School of Informatics, Computing, and Engineering

Bachelor of Science in Informatics | Expected May 2027

Minors: Business Technology, User Experience Research | GPA: 3.55/4.00 | Hudson & Holland Scholar (Full-Ride Scholarship)

Study Abroad: Universidad Complutense de Madrid, Spain | Spring 2026

Research & Professional Experience

Stealth AI Startup Bloomington, IN

Uncanny Valley | *Anthropomorphism* | *Trust Calibration*

Digital Humans & Agentic AI Researcher Oct 2026 to Present

- Research the uncanny valley, anthropomorphism, and social presence in digital humans, examining how human likeness influences perceived authenticity and user trust.
- Investigate **4** digital human interaction characteristics: facial realism, synthetic speech, conversational responsiveness, and emotional expression, to understand factors contributing to user discomfort.
- Examine agentic AI workflows through information retrieval, contextual reasoning, explainability, and human oversight, focusing on information asymmetry and user control.
- Explore **5** human-AI interaction dimensions: trust calibration, perceived control, authenticity, social presence, and willingness to reuse intelligent systems.

National Science Foundation Bloomington, IN

Health Informatics | *Predictive Analytics* | *Responsible AI*

Healthcare Technology Intern June 2026 to July 2026

- Investigated generative AI applications across **4** healthcare technology areas: clinical documentation, predictive analytics, patient-facing technologies, and healthcare information systems.
- Examined algorithmic bias, information accuracy, interpretability, and patient trust in AI-assisted healthcare decision-making.
- Explored **3** responsible AI considerations: data privacy, explainability, and human oversight in healthcare information delivery.

Public Interest Technology University Network (PIT-UN) Bloomington, IN

Public Interest Technology | *Responsible AI* | *Human-Centred Computing*

Agentic AI Experience Research Intern June 2024 to July 2024

- Explored responsible AI, information accessibility, human-centred computing, and the social implications of automated decision-making.
- Investigated AI-enabled information workflows focused on equitable information access, user autonomy, and public-interest technology.
- Examined **3** responsible technology principles: algorithmic transparency, inclusive information delivery, and human control over intelligent systems.

Technical & Research Skills

Programming & Data: Python, SQL, JavaScript, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Relational Databases

AI & Information Science: Large Language Models, Generative AI, Digital Humans, Agentic Systems, Information Retrieval, Information Behaviour, Human-AI Interaction

Research Concepts: Uncanny Valley, Anthropomorphism, Social Presence, Trust Calibration, Algorithm Aversion, Information Asymmetry, Responsible AI

Research Methods: Literature Review, UX Research, Usability Evaluation, Comparative Analysis, Human-AI Interaction Study Design, Requirements Analysis, Technical Documentation

Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Figma, React.js, HTML, CSS

Additional: WCAG 2.1 AA Accessibility, Digital Literacy, Stakeholder Communication

Selected Project

Matcha x Moxie | **Independent STEM Education Initiative** matchaxmoxie.github.io/matchaxmoxie/

- Developed an educational technology hub featuring **3** technical learning pathways covering Python, web development, and Git/GitHub.
- Organised programming tutorials, technical handoffs, and accessible learning resources to support independent learning among first-generation and low-income students.
- Applied information architecture and human-centred design principles to improve the discoverability, organisation, and accessibility of technical learning materials.